Corpus Linguistics

Reading argument 3

Name: _____ ID: _____

Question 1 (Review [Account 1]: L1 Transfer Account)

Which of the following best synthesizes the empirical evidence regarding the L1 transfer account for 'passive' unaccusative errors?

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(A) Although the error matches European compound tenses, its presence among Asian learners disproves the strong L1 transfer account.

(B) Because Asian languages lack auxiliary compound tenses, Asian L2 learners almost never produce these unaccusative be+en error structures.

(C) Because structural parallels exist in European languages, Oshita identifies L1 auxiliary transfer as the primary cause of errors.

(D) Although L1 transfer explains initial learner errors, advanced L2 learners completely eliminate these non-target forms in writing.

Question 2 (Review [Account 2]: Adjectival Passive Account)

Which of the following accurately describes why Oshita evaluates the "Adjectival Passive Overgeneralization" account as weak?

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(A) While short passives supported this account, Oshita doubts it because errors occur in dynamic contexts and lack attributive uses.

(B) Because native English strictly prohibits adjectival participles from unaccusative verbs, Oshita immediately rejects this hypothesis on theoretical grounds.

(C) While learners frequently attach agentive by-phrases, Oshita accepts this account because the errors function as purely stative adjectives.

(D) Because L2 learners produce these errors to express stative meanings, Oshita adopts the adjectival passive account as his primary explanation.

Question 3 ([Account 3]: Non-target Lexical Causativization Account)

Regarding the lexical causativization account, which statement accurately describes the empirical evidence and Oshita's critique?

(A) Although learners occasionally produce active causatives, Oshita rejects this account because active causative errors are far rarer than passive unaccusatives.

(B) Because active causatives occur at identical frequencies with passive unaccusatives, Oshita fully endorses lexical causativization as the primary error source.

(C) While active causatives never occur in learner writing, Oshita adopts lexical causativization because learners silently conceptualize an external agentive causer.

(D) While learners frequently passivize alternating unaccusatives, Oshita rejects this account because nonalternating unaccusatives never exhibit ungrammatical passive structures.

Question 4 ([Account 4]: Overgeneralization of Verbal Passives / Discourse Account)

Regarding the overgeneralization of verbal passives, why does Oshita conclude that this hypothesis cannot fully explain learner errors?

(A) While discourse contexts sometimes imply causers, Oshita considers this account insufficient because passive unaccusatives frequently occur in purely non-agentive, spontaneous contexts.

(B) Because learners only passivize unaccusatives when an external agent is explicitly mentioned, Oshita confirms that verbal passive rules apply quite directly.

(C) While implicit agent suppression triggers error patterns, Oshita argues that L2 learners produce passive unaccusatives mainly to emphasize pragmatic discourse focus.

(D) Although passive unaccusative structures lack surface subjects, Oshita demonstrates that learners overgeneralize verbal passives primarily to avoid incorrect postverbal object placement.

Question 5 ([Account 5]: Overt Marking of Syntactic Movement)

Which of the following is **NOT** mentioned by Oshita as a component or supporting argument in his proposal (Account 5) for *be*+*en* errors?

(A) Oshita argues that L2 learners insert passive morphology to overtly mark syntactic NP-

movement from the underlying object to the surface subject position.

(B) Oshita notes that unergative verbs rarely display this error because their single argument originates directly in the surface subject position without movement.

(C) Oshita claims that L2 learners produce passive unaccusatives primarily because explicit grammar-based classroom instruction encourages passive structural overgeneralization.

(D) Oshita highlights that target English passives overtly signal syntactic object-to-subject movement, prompting L2 learners to overgeneralize the morphological marker to unaccusatives.

Question 6 Your view

Given the review provided by Oshita, what do you think triggers 'passive' unaccusative errors? You don't have to agree with Oshita's explanation/conclusion. Write a paragraph or two to explain your own perspective.